

1Q25 Result: PPOP Beat, Asset Quality Intact Despite Higher GP

DBS reported 1Q25 net profit of S\$2.9bn, -2% yoy/+15% qoq, 7% ahead of cons although 7% below JEF. PPOP was +6% yoy/+19% qoq, 6% ahead of cons and in line with JEF, mainly led by non-II +8% yoy/+25% qoq, 7%/1% ahead of cons/JEF. SP was stable at 10bps, with insignificant NPL formation. Provisions were higher mainly due to GP. Fully loaded CET1 is 15.2%, +0.1ppt qoq. Maintain our preference for DBS.

Key positives - **1) NII resilient**, +5% yoy/-1% qoq, broadly in line with JEF/cons. NIM -3bps qoq to 2.12%, with a decline in commercial book NIM (-9bps qoq to 2.68%) offset by lower funding costs for trading. Loans rose 2% qoq in constant currency terms, driven by +3% qoq growth in non-trade corp loans offsetting 1% decline in trade loans. Deposit growth was +3% qoq, also on constant currency. **2) Non-II strong**. Fee income +22% yoy/+32% qoq, led by wealth +35% yoy/+39% qoq and loan related fees +23% yoy/+79% qoq. AUM grew +1.4% qoq to new high of S\$432bn. Elsewhere, market trading was +3% yoy/+54% qoq, treasury sales were +11% yoy/+32% qoq, although total trading and other income was -6% yoy/+17% qoq due to non-recurrence of one-off gains. **3) Healthy CIR** at 37%, flat yoy. Expenses grew +6% yoy, in line with revenue, and -8% qoq on seasonality. **4) Capital return dividend**. As previously communicated, DBS declared a 15c capital return DPS on top of its regular 60c quarterly DPS. Total DPS rose +39% yoy to 75c.

Key negatives - **1) Higher CoR**, +17bps yoy/+10bps qoq to 30bps. SP was stable yoy at 10bps and improved 10bps qoq, meaning the increase in CoR was mainly due to GP. NPL ratio is 1.1%, flat qoq, with new NPA only at S\$159mn (-50% yoy/-53% qoq). NPA coverage improved +8ppt qoq to 137%.

Outlook - **1)** Business momentum resilient in Apr but risk from heightened uncertainty. **2)** Group NII slightly above 2024 based on 3 rate cuts (previously based on 2 rate cuts), with lower NIM offset by balance sheet growth. **3)** Commercial book non-II growth to be at MSD to HSD (vs. previously HSD). **4)** CIR in low-40% range (unchanged). **5)** SP assumed to normalise to 17-20bps (unchanged), with GP reserves to provide buffer. **6)** Net profit to be below 2024 levels mainly due to global minimum tax of 15% (unchanged).

Implications - The PPOP beat vs. cons underlines the underlying strength of DBS's franchise. Provision miss was mainly on precautionary GP, while SP and NPA formation remained benign. Outlook was marginally tweaked, mainly a small downgrade in non-II growth. The bank also delivered on its capital return commitment. We maintain our preference for DBS within SG banks.

FLASH NOTE

RATING

BUY

PRICE

SGD42.76*

PRICE TARGET | % TO PT

SGD52.00 | +22%

52W HIGH-LOW

SGD46.97 - SGD32.70

FLOAT (%) | ADV MM (USD)

71.3% | 237.51

MARKET CAP

SGD121.3B | \$94.1B

TICKER

DBS SP

*Prior trading day's closing price unless otherwise noted.

Figure 1 - DBS 1Q25 Result Snapshot

	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	yoy %	qoq %	2024	2025	Cons
P&L (S\$ Mln)										
Net interest income	5,555	5,584	5,587	5,728	5,581	0%	-4%	5,855	6%	5,827
Net fee income	1,543	1,555	1,525	1,575	1,575	20%	0%	1,537	27%	1,534
Other income	1,200	945	1,547	950	915	-4%	-17%	1,073	-27%	915
Total income	8,297	8,084	8,759	8,253	8,061	6%	-7%	8,465	6%	8,257
Operating expenses	(2,178)	(2,177)	(2,245)	(2,303)	(2,216)	6%	-6%	(2,244)	0%	(2,200)
Provision for credit losses	3,479	3,365	3,584	3,181	3,481	6%	10%	3,551	6%	3,480
Asset loss provisions	(135)	(145)	(135)	(135)	(135)	140%	0%	(137)	74%	(135)
Operating profit	3,640	3,542	3,929	2,861	3,369	0%	10%	3,585	-4%	3,352
Net profit	2,851	2,769	3,027	2,522	2,887	-2%	10%	3,088	-7%	2,769
Attributable profit										
DPS (S\$)	1.04	0.98	1.05	0.97	1.03	-1%	0%	1.09	-4%	0.95
DPS (S\$)	0.54	0.54	0.54	0.50	0.75	38%	25%	0.75	0%	0.71
Dividend yield	1.33									
Key balance sheet metrics (S\$mn)										
Assets	424,833	424,837	418,058	436,084	435,295	2%	0%	441,051	-4%	
Liabilities	361,257	361,080	344,862	361,730	375,853	0%	2%			
Assets	783,238	795,111	760,099	827,219	840,523	7%	2%			
Shareholders' equity	61,281	61,809	64,874	65,384	65,305	0%	0%			
Key financial ratios (%)										
First net to full income	18.0%	18.1%	18.7%	17.6%	17.6%	21.0%	2.5ppt	4.5ppt		
Cost to income	27.4%	26.6%	26.1%	25.9%	27.3%	-0.5ppt	(5.0ppt)			
NIM	2.18%	2.18%	2.17%	2.05%	2.12%	2.23%	(7.0ppt)	2.11%	2bp	
Cost to fund (bps)	13	14	12	30	30	(17bp)	(10bp)	17	23bp	
ROA	1.8%	1.4%	1.5%	1.2%	1.4%	(5.2ppt)	(5.2ppt)			
ROE	19.0%	18.0%	19.0%	15.4%	17.3%	(7.2ppt)	(7.2ppt)			
Payable ratio	52.0%	55.0%	51.3%	61.7%	73.0%	20.5ppt	11.5ppt			

Source: Jefferies, Company

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Figure 2 - DBS 1Q25 Result Snapshot

	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	yoy %	qoq %	JEF 1Q25E	Diff	Cons 1Q25E	Diff
P&L (\$\$ MM)											
Net interest income	3,505	3,594	3,597	3,728	3,681	5%	-1%	3,695	0%	3,627	1%
Net fee income	1,043	1,048	1,109	968	1,275	22%	32%	1,137	12%	1,104	15%
Other income	1,009	840	1,047	809	949	-6%	17%	1,073	-12%	976	-3%
Total income	5,557	5,482	5,753	5,505	5,905	6%	7%	5,905	0%	5,707	3%
Overhead expenses	(2,079)	(2,172)	(2,249)	(2,395)	(2,214)	6%	-8%	(2,214)	0%	(2,209)	0%
Pre-provision profit	3,478	3,310	3,504	3,110	3,691	6%	19%	3,691	0%	3,498	6%
Asset loss provisions	(135)	(148)	(130)	(209)	(325)	141%	56%	(187)	74%	(195)	66%
Operating profit	3,343	3,162	3,374	2,901	3,366	1%	16%	3,505	-4%	3,302	2%
Net profit	2,951	2,789	3,027	2,522	2,897	-2%	15%	3,099	-7%	2,709	7%
Attributable profit											
EPS (\$\$)	1.04	0.98	1.05	0.97	1.03	-1%	6%	1.09	-6%	0.95	8%
DPS (\$\$)	0.54	0.54	0.54	0.60	0.75	39%	25%	0.75	0%	0.71	6%
Bonus share impact	1.10										
Key balance sheet items (\$\$mn)											
Gross Loan	424,833	424,837	418,068	436,684	435,295	2%	0%	441,051	-1%		
Deposit	547,197	551,088	544,961	561,730	575,663	5%	2%				
Asset	783,208	790,111	789,609	827,219	840,823	7%	2%				
Shareholders' equity	61,291	62,909	64,874	66,394	66,305	8%	0%				
Key financial ratios (%)											
Fee as % of income	18.8%	19.1%	19.3%	17.6%	21.6%	2.8pp	4.0pp				
Cost to income	37.4%	39.6%	39.1%	43.5%	37.5%	0.1pp	(6.0pp)				
NIM	2.14%	2.14%	2.11%	2.15%	2.12%	(2bp)	(3bp)	2.11%	1bp		
Credit cost (bps)	13	14	12	20	30	17bp	10bp	17	13bp		
ROA	1.6%	1.4%	1.5%	1.2%	1.4%	(0.2pp)	0.1pp				
ROE	19.5%	18.0%	19.0%	15.4%	17.5%	(2.1pp)	2.1pp				
Payout ratio	52.0%	55.0%	51.3%	61.7%	73.0%	20.9pp	11.3pp				

Source: Jefferies, Company

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DBS Group Holdings Ltd. is an investment holding company that engages in the provision of retail, small and medium-sized enterprise, corporate and investment banking services. It operates through the following business segments: Consumer or Private Banking, Institutional Banking, Treasury, and Others. The Consumer or Private Banking segment provides services such as current and savings accounts, fixed deposits, loans and home finance, cards, payments, investment and insurance products. The Institutional Banking segment offers financial services and products to institutional clients including non-bank financial institutions, government linked companies, large corporate and small and medium-sized businesses. The Treasury segment supplies treasury services to corporations, institutional and private investors, financial institutions and other market participants. The Others segment encompasses activities from corporate decisions, and income and expenses not attributed to the business segments described. The company was founded in 1968 and is headquartered in Singapore.

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DBS Group Holdings Ltd.

Our PT of S\$52 is based on an 13x multiple to 12m forward EPS. Key upside risks include better-than-expected loan growth, margins and asset quality. Key downside risks include worse-than-expected asset quality/any large NPA formation, dialling down of rate hike/steeper yield curve expectations

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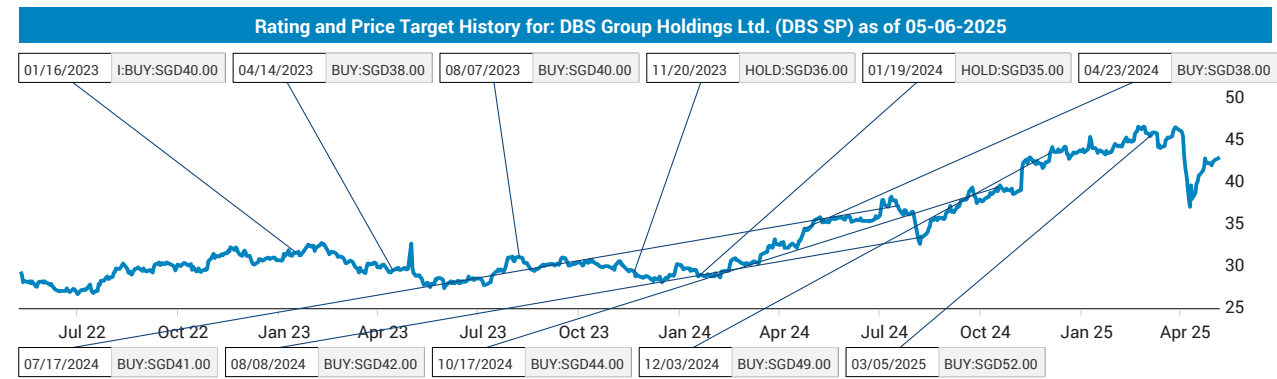
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Legend:

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B: Buy

H: Hold

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